

LIKE A GOOD NEIGHBOR...

TEXT: Luke 10:30-37 (NKJV) *“A certain man went down from Jerusalem to Jericho, and fell among thieves, who stripped him of his clothing, wounded him, and departed, leaving him half dead. ³¹ Now by chance a certain priest came down that road. And when he saw him, he passed by on the other side.³² Likewise a Levite, when he arrived at the place, came and looked, and passed by on the other side. ³³ But a certain Samaritan, as he journeyed, came where he was. And when he saw him, he had compassion. ³⁴ So he went to him and bandaged his wounds, pouring on oil and wine; and he set him on his own animal, brought him to an inn, and took care of him. ³⁵ On the next day, when he departed, he took out two denarii, gave them to the innkeeper, and said to him, ‘Take care of him; and whatever more you spend, when I come again, I will repay you.’ ³⁶ So which of these*

three do you think was neighbor to him who fell among the thieves?”³⁷ And he said, “He who showed mercy on him.” Then Jesus said to him, “Go and do likewise.”

INTRO: Today we begin a new series, “*Love Thy Neighbor.*” I think this is a brilliant series to follow the “*I Am Community Transformation*” with. Today I have chosen the subject, “*Like A Good Neighbor.*” ([Play the State Farm Commercial – “Like a good neighbor, State Farm is there.”](#)) (Fear Thy Neighbor – The difference between good neighbors and bad neighbors)

This story as told by Jesus is full of dramatic happenings:

- The setting is the road from Jerusalem to Jericho. ([The Valley of the Shadow of Death – Pics of screen here](#))
- Thieves have attacked an innocent man.
- An innocent man is left – Half dead. (Bad things happen to good people – “*He takes*

what the enemy meant for evil and turns it for our good.” “All things work together for good...”)

Three people groups enter the scene:

- A priest – Religion
- A Levite – The World
- A Samaritan – Compassion

Religion and the world will leave one half dead
– The one thing religion and the world have in common is that they both lack compassion.
Compassion is what makes us like Jesus.

SIX ACTIONS OF COMPASSION

- 1) He went to Him – He placed his life on pause and went to where the wounded was laying. If we are going to be a Good Neighbor, we must take action – We are to be people of action!
- 2) He bandaged the wounds – Probably tearing his own clothes – If we are going to be a Good Neighbor, we must be

conscious of what is needed by the hurting around us, and respond accordingly.

- 3) He poured oil and wine onto this man's wounds – The oil soothed the wounds, and the wine disinfected the wounds. If we are going to be a Good Neighbor, we must be willing to bear the cost of compassion!
- 4) He placed the wounded man on his own beast – This meant he probably had to walk – and the terrain was rugged. ([Place pics of The Valley of the Shadow of Death back on the screen here](#)) If we are going to be a Good Neighbor, we must not be afraid to get our hands dirty making contact with the hurting.
- 5) He took him to an inn – He made sure he got the man out of the elements and into a more healing environment. If we are going to be a Good Neighbor, we must be willing to help change the environment of those who are hurting.
- 6) He paid the bill for his housing and medical bills – He also offered to return

and pay whatever was lacking. If we are going to be a Good Neighbor, we must be willing to do more than dump and run – We must be engaged throughout the journey of recovery for those who are hurting!

FIVE REQUIREMENTS FOR BEING A GOOD NEIGHBOR

The Good Samaritan was motivated by compassion. There are five characteristics of compassion:

- Compassion is the catalyst of real ministry – All other motivations fall short.
- Compassion is based on need not on merit – We should reach to people because God loves them, not because they deserve it.
- Compassion is based on a feeling – that feeling is compassion – Compassion places the individual in the place of the hurting.
- Compassion is active, not passive – Compassion does more than feel sorry for

the plight of others – compassion **MUST** take action.

- Compassion ignores personal cost, and moves in the direction of rescue irrespective of cost – The constant pattern of the activity of God is rescue – That is the constant pattern of the individual that is determined to be A Good Neighbor.

WHY SHOULD WE BE SO INTENT ON BEING A GOOD NEIGHBOR

1) Because we were created for service. Ephesians 2:10 (NKJV) *“For we are His workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared beforehand that we should walk in them.”*

2) It proves we belong to Christ. Romans 7:4 (NKJV) *“Therefore, my brethren, you also have become dead to the law through the body of Christ, that you may be married to another—to Him who was raised from the dead, that we should bear fruit to God.”*

We are dead to the Law – We are married to

Jesus – We are committed to be the hands and feet of Jesus in the world. Colossians 3:23-24 (NKJV) ***“And whatever you do, do it heartily, as to the Lord and not to men, ²⁴ knowing that from the Lord you will receive the reward of the inheritance; for you serve the Lord Christ.”***

3) It is the best use of our lives. 1 Corinthians 15:58 (NKJV) ***“Therefore, my beloved brethren, be steadfast, immovable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, knowing that your labor is not in vain in the Lord.”***

4) It will be rewarded in eternity. John 12:26 (NKJV) ***“If anyone serves Me, let him follow Me; and where I am, there My servant will be also. If anyone serves Me, him My Father will honor.”*** Matthew 25:21 (NKJV) ***“His lord said to him, ‘well done, good and faithful servant; you were faithful over a few things, I will make you ruler over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.’”***

CONCLUSION:

Susan and I desire to lead Community Transformation Church in being a Good Neighbor community of believers.

We want this Church to Love its Neighbors and Neighborhoods!